

Mathematics

A Cultural Heritage

Lecture 2

Numbers:

Live Discussion

Course Topics

*Funny Side of
Mathematics*

Mathematics,
literatures, movies,
and more

*Mathematics
and the Arts*

Mathematics
and Education

Two mathematics
cultures and a few
mathematical lives

Numbers

Numbers
at work

Our Obsessions
with Numbers

**Mathematics
and Society**

Mathematics and Truth
(Philosophical Aspects
of Mathematics)

**THEOREMS (PROBLEMS)
AND PROOFS**

Teacher Introductions



Dr. Ben Kane

Consultation hours:
Tues. 10-13
Office: Run Run Shaw
Building 411/Zoom



Dr. Rachel Lui

Office: Hui Oi Chow Science
Building 224
Meetings: By appointment



Dr. Alex Shum

Office: Hui Oi Chow Science
Building 223
Meetings: By appointment

Logistics: Continued

1. Any concerns about assignments?
2. Please contact us if there are issues (tutorial registration, technical issues, etc.)
3. General questions about the course logistics?

Questions/Discussion

1. How do we process numbers?
2. Do numbers have cultural meaning or significance?
3. What do we do with numbers? Why are they important?

Last Week's In-Class Assignment

1. With many Common Core options, why did you choose this course and what do you expect to see in this course?

Reasons for Choosing the Course

1. Keen Interest in Mathematics (23)
2. Learn the history / development of mathematics (12)
3. Answer the question(s) “Why do we study math” and “How does math affect our daily life” (12)
4. To gain a different perspective/gain appreciation for math (11)
5. Good at calculations, but want broader view (11)
6. Want to understand the beauty of mathematics (4)

Reasons for Choosing the Course

- 7. Interested in mathematics and social sciences; what is the overlap? (3)
- 8. The title seemed interesting (3)
- 9. Most of the CCST courses look boring (1)
- 10. Course doesn't require higher level math (1)
- 11. Want to learn about math and art (1)
- 12. Want to learn about math and music (2)

Reasons for Choosing the Course

- 13. Interested in the utility of mathematics (1)
- 14. Good at math/science (1)

This Week's In-Class Assignment

1. On a scale of 0 (extremely low) to 10 (extremely high), rate your own mathematical ability by circling your choice:

[extremely low] **0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10** [extremely high]

2. Write a few words on the reason of why you achieved such a level of mathematical ability (e.g., I find mathematics boring, or I had some inspiring teachers, etc.)